CityIQ

City Survival Intelligence App — Product Requirements Document

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1. Executive Summary

CityIQ is a mobile-first intelligence platform that transforms the experience of relocating to a new city. Unlike traditional housing or maps platforms that provide raw data, CityIQ delivers experience simulations — helping users understand what life will actually feel like in any given area before they commit to moving there.

The platform aggregates crowd-sourced local insights, real-time data feeds (traffic, rent, cost of living), and an AI layer to provide personalized, predictive city intelligence across Indian metros and international cities like Dubai.

Attribute	Value
Product Name	CityIQ
Tagline	"Know a city before you live in it"
Platform	Android (MVP), iOS (Phase 2)
Primary Markets	Delhi, Bangalore, Mumbai, Pune, Hyderabad, Dubai
Target Users	Relocating professionals, students, remote workers, expats
Tech Stack	Flutter, Node.js, PostgreSQL, Redis, Elasticsearch, Claude AI
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2. Problem Statement

2.1 The Relocation Problem

Every year, millions of people relocate to new cities for jobs, education, or lifestyle changes. The process of selecting a neighbourhood is fraught with uncertainty because the available information tools are misaligned with what decision-makers actually need.

Pain Point	Why Existing Tools Fail
Which area is safe?	Maps show geography, not safety context or crime patterns
Actual rent vs advertised rent	Housing portals show listing prices, not negotiated reality
Hidden cost of living	No tool consolidates rent + food + transport + lifestyle into one picture
Commute pain / traffic reality	Maps show current traffic; not historical peak-hour patterns or stress levels
Local scams & bad areas	No platform surfaces community-verified warnings
Social life & livability	Lifestyle factors are entirely absent from housing platforms

2.2 Market Opportunity

India sees approximately 9 million domestic migrants annually (urban-to-urban). The GCC region sees 500,000+ professional expat arrivals per year. No dedicated relocation intelligence product exists for these cohorts — current tools (MagicBricks, 99acres, Google Maps) were designed for listing discovery, not life simulation.

3. Goals & Objectives

3.1 Product Goals

- Deliver an experience simulation engine that converts raw city data into personalised livability insights
- Build the most trusted crowd-intelligence layer for neighbourhood-level insights in Indian metros
- Create a monetisable data asset through aggregated, anonymised area intelligence
- Achieve 50,000 MAU within 12 months of launch in 3 cities

3.2 Success Metrics (KPIs)

Metric	MVP Target (Month 6)	Growth Target (Month 12)
Monthly Active Users	10,000	50,000
Areas covered	50 (Delhi NCR)	200 (3 cities)
Community reviews	5,000	50,000
AI queries per day	500	5,000
Paid subscribers	200	2,000
Avg session duration	4 min	7 min

4. User Personas

Persona 1 — The Relocating Professional

Field	Detail
Name	Rohan, 27
Situation	Moving from Indore to Bangalore for a ₹18L/year software job at an MNC
Goals	Find a flat under ₹20,000/month within 30 min commute to Whitefield
Fears	Overpaying, being stuck in a flood-prone area, unsafe neighbourhood for girlfriend
Behaviour	Researches heavily online, trusts peer reviews more than ads

Persona 2 — The Student

Field	Detail
Name	Priya, 22
Situation	Starting MBA at IIM Bangalore; needs PG accommodation on tight budget
Goals	Safe area, walkable to campus, good food options under ₹150/meal
Fears	Harassment, poor connectivity, noisy neighbourhoods affecting study
Behaviour	Heavy mobile user, trusts social feeds and direct community input

Persona 3 — The Expat

Field	Detail
Name	James, 34
Situation	British consultant moving to Dubai for 2-year contract
Goals	English-friendly area, expat community, good schools nearby
Fears	Cultural mismatch, overspending on rent, long commute to DIFC
Behaviour	Willing to pay for premium insights, wants verified local knowledge

5. Feature Requirements

5.1 MVP Features (Phase 1 — Month 0 to 4)

FR-01: Area Intelligence Score

Each neighbourhood is assigned a composite Liveability Score based on four sub-dimensions:

Score Dimension	Data Source	Weight
Safety Score (0–100)	Police open data, community reports, incident density	25%
Cost of Living Score	Rental aggregation, grocery indices, transport costs	25%
Commute Difficulty	Google Maps traffic API, historical peak-hour data	25%
Lifestyle Score	Amenities density, parks, nightlife, schools, hospitals	25%

Acceptance Criteria:

- Score updates refresh every 24 hours for cost/commute data
- Safety score uses 30-day rolling average
- User can tap any dimension score to see breakdown and source data
- Map view shows color-coded heat-map overlay by liveability score

FR-02: Real Cost Calculator

A personalised financial planner that takes user inputs and outputs a realistic monthly budget projection:

Input Parameter	Options
Monthly salary	Free text (INR / AED)
Lifestyle tier	Basic / Moderate / Comfortable / Luxury
Number of occupants	Solo / Couple / Family
Work location	Map pin or area name

Output — Monthly Breakdown Table:

Expense Category	Estimate Logic	Shown As
Rent	Area median ± lifestyle tier	Range (₹12k – ₹18k)
Food	Per-capita meal cost × lifestyle	Daily + Monthly

Transport	Commute distance × mode × frequency	Monthly total
Utilities	Area average electricity/water/internet	Fixed estimate
Entertainment	Lifestyle tier multiplier	Monthly budget
Savings prediction	Salary minus all above	Amount + % of income

FR-03: Commute Simulator

User selects a work location and a residential area to simulate the commute experience:

- Peak-hour commute time (7–10 AM, 5–9 PM)
- Off-peak commute time
- Traffic stress level: Low / Medium / High / Nightmare
- Recommended transport mode and cost per month
- Alternative route suggestions

FR-04: Reality Feed

A community-powered, moderated feed of hyperlocal insights:

- Posts are tagged by category: Safety, Noise, Infrastructure, Food, Flooding, Power Cuts, Social
- Each post tied to a specific area polygon (not just city-level)
- Upvote/downvote system — highly upvoted posts surfaced in Area Score cards
- Verified Local badge for users who confirm residence via utility bill or telecom data
- AI moderation layer flags spam, hate speech, and irrelevant posts
- Posts expire after 90 days unless re-confirmed by community

FR-05: AI City Assistant

A conversational AI interface powered by Claude API:

- Natural language queries: 'Best area under ₹15k in Delhi near metro'
- Personalised to user profile (salary, lifestyle, work location)
- Synthesises Area Score + Cost Calculator + Reality Feed into holistic recommendations
- Handles follow-up questions within session context
- Response must cite the data sources used in the recommendation

5.2 Phase 2 Features (Month 5 to 8)

- FR-06: Area Comparison Tool — Side-by-side visual comparison of 2–4 areas
- FR-07: Moving Checklist Generator — AI-generated personalised pre-move task list
- FR-08: Neighbourhood Change Alerts — Push notification when a followed area's score changes significantly
- FR-09: Broker Directory with Verified Reviews — Anti-scam layer for rental search
- FR-10: iOS App Launch

5.3 Phase 3 Features (Month 9 to 12)

- FR-11: Data API for B2B clients (HR tech, relocation companies)

- FR-12: Employer Relocation Packages — White-label dashboard for companies onboarding employees
- FR-13: International city expansion — Dubai, Singapore, London (expat markets)

6. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement	Target
Performance	API response time (95th percentile)	< 800ms
Performance	App cold start time	< 2.5 seconds
Performance	Map tile load time	< 1.5 seconds
Scalability	Concurrent users supported	10,000 (Phase 1)
Availability	Platform uptime SLA	99.5%
Security	Data encryption at rest & transit	AES-256 / TLS 1.3
Privacy	User data handling	GDPR + PDPB compliant
Accessibility	Text size & contrast	WCAG 2.1 AA

7. User Stories (Priority Backlog)

ID	User Story	Priority	Story Points
US-001	As a user, I can search for an area and see its Liveability Score with breakdown	P0	8
US-002	As a user, I can enter my salary and see a cost breakdown for any area	P0	13
US-003	As a user, I can simulate my commute from home to office with peak-hour times	P0	8
US-004	As a user, I can read community posts about real experiences in an area	P0	5
US-005	As a user, I can post a reality insight tagged to a specific area	P1	5
US-006	As a user, I can ask the AI assistant for area recommendations in natural language	P1	13
US-007	As a user, I can compare two areas side by side on key metrics	P1	8
US-008	As a user, I can save areas to a shortlist and revisit them	P2	3
US-009	As a user, I receive alerts when a saved area's score changes significantly	P2	5
US-010	As a premium user, I can see historical score trends for any area	P2	8

8. Constraints, Assumptions & Risks

8.1 Constraints

- Initial launch limited to Android due to Flutter-first strategy and budget
- Area Intelligence data quality dependent on user-generated content volume in early months
- Google Maps API costs must be managed — aggressive caching required from Day 1
- AI API (Claude) costs scale with query volume; must implement smart caching layer

8.2 Key Assumptions

- Users in metros are willing to contribute reviews if the UX is frictionless
- Landlords / brokers will not be able to game the system at scale given moderation layer
- Government open data portals (data.gov.in) provide usable datasets for safety/infrastructure

8.3 Risk Register

Risk	Impact	Likelihood	Mitigation
Data cold-start (thin reviews at launch)	High	High	Seed with scraped public data + partner with relocation communities
Google Maps API cost overrun	Medium	Medium	Implement aggressive Redis caching; use Mapbox fallback
Review spam / broker manipulation	High	Medium	AI moderation + Verified Local badge + rate limiting
Competitor (NoBroker, MagicBricks) copies features	Medium	High	Speed to market; build community moat before competitors react
AI hallucinations in recommendations	High	Low	Ground all AI responses in retrieved data; no freeform generation

9. Acceptance Criteria Summary

The MVP will be considered launch-ready when:

- All P0 user stories pass QA with zero critical bugs
- Area Intelligence Scores are live for minimum 50 areas in Delhi NCR
- Real Cost Calculator produces output within 2 seconds for any Delhi area
- AI Assistant answers 90% of test queries with relevant, data-backed responses
- Reality Feed has minimum 500 seeded community posts across launch areas
- App achieves 4.0+ rating in internal beta with 100 testers